

C804

Medical Terminology

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A medical assistant at a family practice that opened a second location explains the term gastroenteritis to a new student. The student is studying part-time. What does gastroenteritis mean?

- A. A cancer of the stomach.
- B. Inflammation of the stomach and intestines.
- C. Inflammation of the stomach only.
- D. Study of the stomach and intestines.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

A surgeon at a teaching hospital with a new robotic system creates a permanent opening from the colon to the surface of the abdomen. The procedure took 3 hours. What is it called?

- A. Colotomy.
- B. Colostomy.
- C. Colectomy.
- D. Colitis.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A surgical report says a patient had an appendectomy. What was done?

- A. The appendix was surgically removed.
- B. A new opening was made from the appendix.
- C. The appendix was cut into.
- D. The appendix was inflamed.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A patient at a cardiology clinic with an ocean view has a resting heart rate of 48 beats per minute. The patient is 72 years old and a former swimmer. Which term describes this rate?

- A. Tachycardia.
- B. Hypotension.
- C. Bradycardia.
- D. Arrhythmia.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which term describes blood glucose above the normal range?

- A. Glycosuria.
- B. Hypoglycemia.
- C. Hyperglycemia.
- D. Tachyglycemia.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

At an urgent care center that is open 24 hours, a clinician notes a fracture of the radius near the wrist, far from the elbow. The patient fell while skateboarding. Which term describes the fracture's position relative to the elbow?

- A. Lateral.
- B. Distal.
- C. Proximal.
- D. Superficial.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which term describes a structure closer to the midline of the body?

- A. Anterior.
- B. Lateral.
- C. Medial.
- D. Proximal.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A report from a kidney center with a new dialysis wing uses the term nephrolithiasis. The patient is a long-distance truck driver. What condition is this?

- A. Kidney stones.
- B. Inflammation of the kidney.
- C. Gallstones.
- D. A general kidney condition.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

At a clinic that recently extended its hours, a patient's lab work shows antibodies against the hepatitis B surface antigen after vaccination. In this case, what is the antigen?

- A. The B lymphocytes.
- B. Any bacterium in the body, since all antigens are bacteria.
- C. The antibodies the body made.
- D. The hepatitis B surface protein.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A pathology report from a cancer center with a new healing garden reads "osteosarcoma with metastasis to the lungs." The patient is a 17-year-old basketball player. What does this mean?

- A. A malignant bone tumor that has spread to the lungs.
- B. An epithelial cancer that began in the lungs.
- C. Lung cancer that spread to the bone.
- D. A benign bone tumor that has not spread.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Malignant cells arise from epithelial tissue but have not invaded beyond their original layer. Which term fits?

- A. Metastatic carcinoma.
- B. Sarcoma in situ.
- C. Benign adenoma.
- D. Carcinoma in situ.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A counselor at a community center with a new basketball court notes that a client has an intense, irrational fear of open or crowded places and avoids leaving home. The client works from home as an accountant. Which term fits?

- A.** Claustrophobia.
- B.** Mania.
- C.** Any worry about crowds, which is always a phobia.
- D.** Agoraphobia.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	____	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer B Concept 1

A medical assistant at a family practice ~~that opened a second location~~ explains the term gastroenteritis to a new student. ~~The student is studying part time.~~ What does gastroenteritis mean?

Target word: meaning **Decides:** gastr/o + enter/o + -itis.

A	Adjacent category	-itis signals inflammation, not a tumor.
B	Correct	gastr/o = stomach, enter/o = intestine, -itis = inflammation.
C	Dropped element	Drops the enter/o root.
D	Confusion set	That is gastroenterology (-logy).

2. Answer B Concept 2

A surgeon at a teaching hospital ~~with a new robotic system~~ creates a permanent opening from the colon to the surface of the abdomen. ~~The procedure took 3 hours.~~ What is it called?

Target word: procedure term **Decides:** Creating a new opening.

A	Dropped element	An incision into the colon without a lasting opening.
B	Correct	-ostomy means creating an opening.
C	Confusion set	-ectomy means removal.
D	Adjacent category	A condition (inflammation), not a procedure.

3. Answer A Concept 2 · transfer

A surgical report says a patient had an appendectomy. What was done?

Target word: reverse: term given, name the act **Decides:** -ectomy.

A	Correct	-ectomy means removal.
B	Inverted operation	That would be -ostomy, which keeps the organ and opens it.
C	Confusion set	That would be -otomy.
D	Adjacent category	That is appendicitis, a condition.

4. Answer C Concept 3

A patient at a cardiology clinic ~~with an ocean view~~ has a resting heart rate of 48 beats per minute. ~~The patient is 72 years old and a former swimmer.~~ Which term describes this rate?

Target word: rate term **Decides:** Below 60 beats per minute is slow.

A	Inverted operation	tachy- means fast.
B	Confusion set	Low blood pressure, not heart rate.
C	Correct	brady- = slow; cardia = heart.
D	Adjacent category	Describes an irregular rhythm, not a slow rate.

5. Answer C Concept 3 • transfer

Which term describes blood glucose above the normal range?

Target word: reverse: meaning given, pick the term **Decides:** Above normal = hyper-.

A	Adjacent category	Sugar in the urine, not the blood.
B	Inverted operation	hypo- means below normal.
C	Correct	hyper- = above; glyc = sugar; -emia = blood.
D	Confusion set	tachy- refers to speed, not amount.

6. Answer B Concept 4

At an urgent care center ~~that is open 24 hours~~, a clinician notes a fracture of the radius near the wrist, far from the elbow. ~~The patient fell while skateboarding.~~ Which term describes the fracture's position relative to the elbow?

Target word: direction term **Decides:** Farther from the point of attachment.

A	Adjacent category	Lateral describes distance from the midline, not along a limb.
B	Correct	Distal means farther from the trunk or attachment point.
C	Inverted operation	Proximal means closer to the attachment point.
D	Confusion set	Describes depth from the surface.

7. Answer C Concept 4 • transfer

Which term describes a structure closer to the midline of the body?

Target word: reverse: meaning given, pick the term **Decides:** Toward the midline.

A	Adjacent category	Refers to the front of the body.
B	Inverted operation	Lateral means away from the midline.
C	Correct	Medial means toward the midline.
D	Confusion set	Refers to position along a limb.

8. Answer A Concept 5

A report from a kidney center ~~with a new dialysis wing~~ uses the term nephrolithiasis. ~~The patient is a long-distance truck driver.~~ What condition is this?

Target word: condition **Decides:** nephro + lith + -iasis.

A	Correct	nephro = kidney; lith = stone; -iasis = condition.
B	Adjacent category	That is nephritis.
C	Confusion set	That is cholelithiasis.
D	Dropped element	Drops the lith (stone) root.

9. Answer D Concept 6

At a clinic ~~that recently extended its hours~~, a patient's lab work shows antibodies against the hepatitis B surface antigen after vaccination. In this case, what is the antigen?

Target word: identify the antigen **Decides:** The foreign marker that triggers the response.

A	Adjacent category	B cells make antibodies; they are not the antigen.
B	Absolute language	Antigens can be viral, bacterial, or other foreign markers.
C	Inverted operation	Antibodies are the response, not the trigger.
D	Correct	The foreign protein triggers antibody production.

10. Answer A Concept 7

A pathology report from a cancer center ~~with a new healing garden~~ reads "osteosarcoma with metastasis to the lungs." ~~The patient is a 17-year-old basketball player.~~ What does this mean?

Target word: meaning **Decides:** oste/o + sarcoma; metastasis names where it spread.

A	Correct	Sarcoma = connective tissue cancer; metastasis = distant spread.
B	Confusion set	Describes a carcinoma, not a sarcoma.
C	Inverted operation	Reverses the origin and the site of spread.
D	Dropped element	Drops both malignancy and metastasis.

11. Answer D Concept 7 · transfer

Malignant cells arise from epithelial tissue but have not invaded beyond their original layer. Which term fits?

Target word: reverse: description given, pick the term **Decides:** Epithelial origin and not invasive.

A	Inverted operation	Metastatic means it has spread.
B	Confusion set	Sarcomas arise from connective tissue.
C	Adjacent category	Benign; the stem says malignant.
D	Correct	Epithelial cancer that is still confined.

12. Answer D Concept 8

A counselor at a community center ~~with a new basketball court~~ notes that a client has an intense, irrational fear of open or crowded places and avoids leaving home. ~~The client works from home as an accountant.~~ Which term fits?

Target word: term **Decides:** Fear of open or crowded places.

A	Confusion set	Fear of enclosed spaces.
B	Adjacent category	Abnormally elevated mood, not fear.
C	Absolute language	A phobia is intense and irrational; ordinary unease is not.
D	Correct	agora- = marketplace (open or crowded places); -phobia = fear.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	4	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	11	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	8	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	2	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	11	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	0	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Building a term from its parts	Read the suffix first, then the prefix and roots in order; every root counts.	Ignoring a second root or the suffix.	A long term with two or more roots.
2	Surgical suffixes	-ectomy = removal; -otomy = incision; -ostomy = creating an opening; -itis = inflammation.	Mixing up -ectomy, -otomy, and -ostomy.	Removed, cut into, or a new opening.
3	Opposite prefixes	hyper- = above/excessive vs. hypo- = below; tachy- = fast vs. brady- = slow.	Picking the opposite prefix.	A number above or below normal.
4	Directional terms	Proximal = closer to the trunk or point of attachment; distal = farther; medial = toward the midline; lateral = away from it.	Reversing proximal and distal.	Closer to or farther from the elbow, shoulder, or midline.
5	Organ roots	nephr/o and ren/o = kidney; hepat/o = liver; chol/e = bile; gastr/o = stomach; lith = stone.	Confusing kidney and gallbladder roots.	A root plus -lithiasis or -itis.
6	Antigen vs. antibody	An antigen is the foreign marker that triggers a response; an antibody is the protein the body makes against it.	Reversing the two.	Something produced vs. something that triggers production.
7	Oncology terms	Carcinoma arises from epithelial tissue and sarcoma from connective tissue; metastasis is spread to a distant site; in situ means not invasive.	Reading the site of spread as the origin.	"With metastasis to ...".
8	Mental health terms	-phobia = irrational fear; agora- = open or crowded places; claustro- = enclosed spaces; -mania = abnormal excitement or compulsion.	Confusing agoraphobia and claustrophobia.	The feared situation.

Course scope (public description): Medical Terminology focuses on the basic components of medical terminology and how terminology is used when discussing various body structures and systems. Proper use of medical terminology is critical for accurate and clear communication among medical staff, health professionals, and patients. In addition to the systems of the body, this course will discuss immunity, infections, mental health, and cancer.